

DEVA ANAND

devaanand@umass.edu | (413) 315-1715 | devaanand.com | github.com/Deva-1903

July 15, 2026

Old Mission
Chicago, IL

Re: Software Developer

Dear Old Mission Hiring Team,

The part of engineering I enjoy most is making code fast and correct at a level most teams never look at, so a development program built around C++ trading tools, where performance and reliability genuinely matter, is exactly where I want to be. I am completing my MS in Computer Science at UMass Amherst, and I would bring a systems-and-performance habit of mind together with real production backend experience.

My favorite recent project is a from-scratch exercise in getting C++ to the metal: I optimized matrix multiplication from a naive baseline through cache-aware tiling, hand-written AVX/SIMD vectorization with register-aware micro-kernels, and OpenMP multithreading, profiling L1/L3/TLB misses with Linux perf and reading the generated assembly to confirm the compiler did what I expected. The instinct there, measure first and then remove only the bottleneck you can prove, is what I would bring to trading applications. I carried the same habit into data systems, cutting a Spark ETL pipeline's runtime about 25% on a 1.4-billion-row dataset by tracking shuffle and skew bottlenecks through stage-level timings.

I am not only a systems person, though. Before grad school I spent two years as a backend engineer at Wysa, where I owned a multi-tenant service for 8+ UK clinical clients, diagnosed production incidents across tenants, and shipped fixes under real stakes. Earlier, at Cario, I designed 20+ production REST APIs and migrated a codebase from JavaScript to TypeScript. Across those roles and my projects I have worked with Python, C++, SQL, JavaScript, React, and Linux, on a solid systems-programming and algorithms foundation, which lines up closely with your stack, and I am comfortable jumping into an unfamiliar codebase and becoming useful quickly.

What draws me to Old Mission specifically is the culture you describe: naturally curious people in a team environment who are never quite satisfied with the current version. That is how I work, and a firm that invests in its own engineers rather than chasing outside capital is a place I would give my best. I would love the chance to contribute immediately and to learn the craft of electronic trading from your team. Thank you for considering my application, and I would welcome the chance to talk.

Sincerely,
Deva Anand